# YELLOW-FOOT TORTOISE

Chelonoidis denticulatus

### What can I see or hear?

Yellow-orange scales on legs and head, dark domed shell, broad jaws. Strong sense of smell — it tracks ripe fruit through dense forest.

### Where does it live, and why?

Amazon rainforest floor — wettest of the South American tortoises. Needs constant humidity and leaf litter to keep from drying out.

### How does it send messages?

Head-bobbing between males in courtship and combat. Subtle tongue and posture cues. Females less demonstrative than males.

### What does it do when something changes?

Tucks deep into shell. In flood, climbs to higher ground. In dry stretches, holes up and waits — fruit is the signal to come out.

### How does it learn?

Memorizes fruit-tree locations across a wide home range. Follows seasonal fruit fall. Recognizes individual keepers.

### How does it have babies?

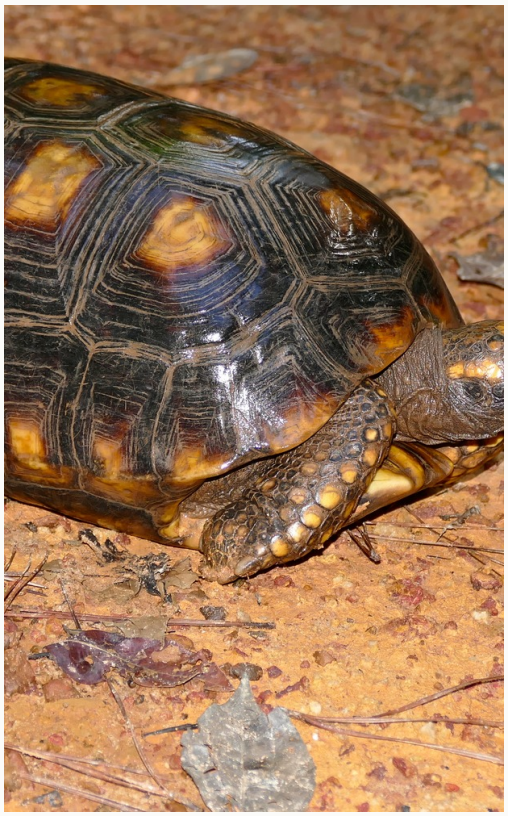
Lays 4 to 12 eggs in a shallow nest, covered with leaves. Around 5 month incubation. Hatchlings independent at hatch.

### What are the limits?

Lifespan 50 to 60 years. Drier or cooler climates kill them. Needs varied diet with cycled fruit and animal protein — never greens alone.

### What does this teach us?

A rainforest animal moves with the rain. Wait for the season instead of fighting against it.



### Think About This

When the season is wrong, do you push or wait?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality. Environment shapes design.